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Black nomads of the Sahara

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Material Not Relevant

The way the Teda take the oath resembles the rites followed by the [Bideyat](#) on a similar occasion.

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To swear on the Koran is something benign among the Teda, but the oath on the liver is not a joke. (13) This is how it was done on the occasion of the reconciliation between two Toubou of Djado in 1943: Around 11 o'clock in the morning some 30 men sat down in the shade of a thorn tree. There were present also a few youngsters stretched out on the sand, and half a dozen women who sat down behind the men. The two adversaries each brought a small ox which they slaughtered. They broiled the livers which they placed on a flat stone held in place by three other stones. Each cut his liver into seven pieces and passed them to the other. They each ate three pieces while swearing every time that they had never and would never cast spells on their

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antagonist. The one swearing thus calls on death to take him that same year if he is lying or if he breaks his oath. The formula is approximately the following: "Grandfather, grandmother, father, mother, may they see me if I do evil, may the liver see me, I have not done evil, may I die within the year if I have done something bad, may the liver see me, may it kill me." After this oath, the spectators hear the reciprocal recriminations of the two plaintiffs (in this particular case: a dispute about a camel and the oversight of a visit of condolence); they discuss it among themselves; the blacksmith himself gives his opinion. When a unanimous opinion seems to be forming, the one on whom the blame is laid yields to the pressure of public opinion thus expressed and pays the anticipated fine for the damage caused, or promises to pay within a given time. Immediately, the spectators declare the matter settled and each one leaves.

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Besides djinns, the Toubous believe in michi or cheitan, that is, in devils. They are recognized by the fact that they have one black eye and one red eye. It is sufficient to fire a gun, to throw an assegai or to tap a stick to put them to flight. Sadagas also have the power to ward off the michi.

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Spirits And Gods

Certain people are thought to have the evil eye. A person protects his field or his dwelling by placing there a skull or a skin of an animal, a broken pot, an old cap, in short,  317389 cont.by making ugly what seems to beautiful and could arouse jealousy. These objects resemble scarecrows and, seeing them, one might believe they are used to frighten birds, predatory animals; in reality they are scarecrows only for "the evil eye".

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Magic

13. Le Coeur, Dictionnaire, article: mahano, liver, p. 140-141.

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